

P5. Cash or Cheap Fuel? — a survey experiment on preferences for compensation

Question. Do Bangladeshis prefer universal cheap fuel or targeted cash compensation? How do trust in the state, perceived corruption and past experience with safety-net programmes shape that preference?

Design. - A conjoint experiment embedded in P1's W1 or run on its own (n~2,000). - Respondents choose between policy packages that vary: fuel price (Tk 135/150/165), compensation (none / Tk 500 / Tk 1,000 per month), targeting (universal / Family Card / employer-based), delivery (bKash/Nagad / union parishad / NGO), and who pays (duty cut / budget / BPC borrowing). - Moderators: sector, prior safety-net receipt, trust, partisanship.

Why it's important. It directly informs the choice the government faces in Oct–Dec. It adds evidence from Bangladesh to the international literature (Iran 2010, Indonesia, Nigeria 2023) on why fuel subsidy reform so often fails politically.

Budget. ~\$8–15k standalone, and small if embedded in P1.